

Annual and Sick Leave Policy

Standards governing annual leave and sick leave

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Effective Date	1 January 2026	Review / Expiry	31 December 2026
Policy Owner	Human Resources	Approving Authority	Head of Human Resources

Policy Statement

This policy establishes the Company's standards and requirements for the matters covered by this document. Employees and managers are expected to comply with these requirements and to provide complete and accurate information when submitting or reviewing requests and claims.

Document Control

Version	Effective Date	Change Summary	Status
1.0	1 January 2026	Initial policy issuance for the 2026 policy year.	Active

Approval

Policy Owner	Human Resources
Approving Authority	Head of Human Resources
Approval Status	Approved for use effective 1 January 2026.

1. Purpose

The purpose of this policy is to provide employees and managers with clear and consistent requirements for requesting and administering annual leave and sick leave. The policy sets the minimum eligibility, notice, duration, balance, and scheduling requirements applicable during the 2026 policy year.

2. Scope

This policy applies to employees of the Company who are recorded as active employees. Leave entitlements are administered according to the employee's applicable leave balance and the Company's approval process.

3. Eligibility

An employee must be actively employed at the time the request is submitted. Leave requests submitted by an employee whose employment status is not Active are not eligible for approval under this policy.

4. Annual Leave

4.1 Entitlement and Balance

Annual leave may be taken only to the extent of the employee's remaining annual leave entitlement for the relevant leave year. The requested number of days must not exceed the employee's available balance.

4.2 Maximum Duration

An annual leave request may cover a maximum of 10 consecutive calendar days. A longer period requires a documented exception and approval from Human Resources before the leave is taken.

4.3 Advance Notice

Employees should submit annual leave requests at least 5 calendar days before the requested start date. Managers may consider operational requirements when reviewing requests, but the minimum notice requirement remains the standard for ordinary annual leave.

4.4 Scheduling

Annual leave is subject to business coverage and manager approval. Leave must not be scheduled over a period for which the employee already has approved leave. Where dates overlap, the later request must be revised or otherwise resolved through Human Resources.

5. Sick Leave

5.1 Entitlement and Balance

Sick leave may be taken only to the extent of the employee's remaining sick leave entitlement for the relevant leave year.

5.2 Maximum Duration

A standard sick leave request may cover a maximum of 5 consecutive calendar days. Longer absences require appropriate medical documentation and Human Resources review.

5.3 Notice

Because illness may be unforeseen, no advance notice period is imposed for sick leave. Employees must nevertheless notify their manager or the designated reporting channel as soon as reasonably practicable after becoming unable to work.

6. Leave Requests and Approval

Employees are responsible for submitting complete and accurate leave requests, including the leave type, start date, end date, and any required supporting information. Managers are responsible for assessing operational coverage and confirming approval in accordance with this policy.

An approval does not create additional leave entitlement. The approved period remains subject to the employee's available balance and the Company's official leave records.

7. Overlapping Leave

A new leave period must not overlap an existing period of approved leave for the same employee. Where an overlap is identified, the employee must amend the request or obtain guidance from Human Resources before approval can be granted.

8. Exceptions

Human Resources may approve an exception to the notice or maximum-duration requirements where there is a documented business, operational, or exceptional personal circumstance. Exceptions must be recorded and must not be treated as a change to the standard entitlement.

9. Responsibilities

- Employees are responsible for maintaining accurate requests, observing notice requirements, and keeping their manager informed of material changes.
- Managers are responsible for reviewing leave requests promptly and ensuring appropriate team coverage.
- Human Resources is responsible for policy interpretation, exception handling, and maintenance of official leave records.

10. Records and Administration

The Company will maintain leave balances, approved leave records, and relevant approvals in its HR systems. These records are the authoritative source for leave administration. This policy is effective through 31 December 2026 unless superseded earlier by an approved policy revision.